

Skills

Performing Oropharyngeal Suctioning

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for the patient's privacy and performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers. Compared the identifiers in the MAR/medical record with the information on the patient's identification bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied a pulse oximeter and obtained the SpO ₂ reading.	☐	☐	☐	
Helped the patient into a semi-Fowler's or sitting position. Raised the bed up and lowered the nearest side rail to facilitate access to the patient.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed for signs that the patient may require suctioning.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient for signs and symptoms of hypoxemia and hypercapnia.	☐	☐	☐	
Draped the patient's neck and chest.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied clean gloves. Put on a mask, gown, or face shield if splashing was likely.	☐	☐	☐	
Filled a cup or basin with approximately 100 mL of sterile water or sterile 0.9% sodium chloride solution.	☐	☐	☐	
Connected one end of the connecting tubing to the suction machine and turned on the suction. Set the vacuum regulator to the appropriate setting. Connected the other end of the tubing to the rigid suction catheter.	☐	☐	☐	

Checked to ensure the suction machine was functioning properly. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed the patient's oxygen mask, if present. Kept the oxygen mask near the patient's face in case he or she desaturated. ☐ ☐ ☐

Inserted the catheter into the patient's mouth, moving along the gum line to the pharynx. Moved the catheter around the mouth until all secretions were cleared. Encouraged the patient to cough. Did not suction the buccal mucosa. Cleared the device by suctioning a small amount of sterile water or sterile normal saline in between passes. Replaced the patient's oxygen mask. ☐ ☐ ☐

Rinsed the catheter with water in a cup or basin until the connecting tubing had been cleared of secretions. Turned off the suction. Disinfected the external catheter surface per manufacturer's directions. Washed the patient's face if necessary. ☐ ☐ ☐

Observed the patient's respiratory status. Repeated the procedure, if indicated. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed towel, cloth, or disposable drape from patient, and placed it in the trash or in the laundry if soiled. Raised the bedside rail and placed the bed in the lowest position to the floor. Repositioned the patient. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed the dry catheter in a clean, dry area. ☐ ☐ ☐

Positioned the recovered patient for comfort, and provided oral hygiene if needed. ☐ ☐ ☐

Discarded the remainder of the sterile water or sterile normal saline into the appropriate receptacle. Discarded the disposable cup into the appropriate receptacle. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed gloves and mask or face shield, and disposed of them in the appropriate receptacles. ☐ ☐ ☐

Performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Helped the patient into a comfortable position, and placed toiletries and personal items within reach. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed the call light within easy reach, and made sure the patient knew how to use it to summon assistance. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised the appropriate number of side rails and lowered the bed to the lowest position. ☐ ☐ ☐

Performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Documented and reported the patient’s response and expected or unexpected outcomes. Documented the procedure, included how the patient tolerated the suctioning. Documented the amount, consistency, color, and odor of any secretions.

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____